Japan v Sweden 6-Snap Trading Diary — Support Guide

This guide teaches the vocabulary behind the 6-Snap Diary, then walks the same match with a single organizing logic: **sportsbook odds → de-vigged fair probability → market consensus → prediction-market share → fees & slippage → tradeability.**

How to use this guide

- The diary is analyst-facing; this companion translates the core ideas for a first-time reader.
- It uses the 6-Snap PDF as the spine — pre-match pricing, match-day steam, the final-hour reversal, in-game repricing, and full-time settlement.
- It keeps the 3-layer decision rule separate on purpose: **fair probability**, the **raw cross-venue gap**, and **after-fee tradeability** are 3 different questions.

> **The one sentence for the whole package.** Price it → strip out the vig → compare it to the rest of the market and the crowd → subtract fees and slippage → only call it tradeable if the edge clears the cost band.

1 · The vig — the book's hidden cut

Start here, because every other number in the diary depends on it. The **vig** — also called **hold**, **juice**, **overround**, or **margin** — is the sportsbook's built-in commission. It is not charged as a separate fee; it is hidden inside the odds.

Odds are a probability written another way

Decimal odds convert straight to an implied probability: **implied % = 1 / decimal odds**. So a 2.00 price implies 50%, a 1.50 price implies 67%, and so on. American odds convert to decimal first (formulas on the last page).

The coin-flip version

A fair coin is 50/50. A book may price *both* sides at –110. Each –110 side implies **52.4%**, so the 2 sides sum to **104.8%**. The extra **4.8%** is the vig.

Term	Who says it	Plain-English meaning
Hold / hold %	Sportsbook operators	The book's margin, realized or expected.
Theoretical hold / theo	Trading desks	Expected margin baked into the price before the result.
Overround	Trading desks	Sum of implied probabilities minus 100%.
Vig / vigorish	Bettor-side language	The cut, collected through the odds.
Juice	Colloquial slang	Informal synonym for vig.

- **Why it matters.** The customer pays the vig whether the ticket wins or loses.
- **Why a desk cares.** A desk strips the vig out before comparing prices across venues.
- **Why beginners get trapped.** A price can look attractive before the hidden cut is removed.

2 · From odds to raw probability (a worked example)

Take Snap 1 of the diary — FanDuel's opening prices on the 3-way match (Japan / Draw / Sweden):

Outcome	FanDuel odds	Decimal	Raw implied probability
Japan	–115	1.87	53.5%
Draw	+240	3.40	29.4%
Sweden	+330	4.30	23.3%

Outcome	FanDuel odds	Decimal	Raw implied probability
Sum			**106.2%**

> **Beginner checkpoint.** The probabilities add to more than 100%. That is not a math error — it is how the sportsbook embeds its margin. Here the overround is 6.2%, i.e. roughly a 6% hold on this match.

3 · De-vigging — turning retail odds into fair probability

De-vigging means removing that margin so the numbers add back to 100%. The simplest method just rescales each outcome by the total:

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de-vigged fair probability  =  raw implied probability  /  sum of raw implied probabilities
```

For Snap 1, Japan's –115 implies about **53.5%** raw. After the 3-way market is normalised back to 100%, Japan becomes **50.4% fair**. **That** is the number to compare with Polymarket — not the 53.5%.

4 · EV, consensus, and why every Japan leg stayed negative-EV

Once you have a fair probability, the next question is whether the price is any *good*. The diary compares FanDuel to a no-vig consensus of rival books.

- **No-vig consensus.** Strip the vig out of the other books and average them — the market's best estimate of true probability.
- **Expected value (EV).** `EV per $1 = decimal odds × consensus probability − 1`
- **Negative EV** = the price is worse than fair (you pay more than the outcome is worth). **Positive EV** = better than fair, but it still must survive limits, fees, and execution.

Snap	FanDuel Japan	No-vig consensus	Japan EV	Plain-English read
1	–115	49.6%	–7.3%	No value at the opening read.
2	–115	50.2%	–6.1%	Still negative, despite a lower hold.
3	–125	51.6%	–7.1%	Japan firmed, but the price was still too expensive.
4	+100	47.7%	–4.7%	Better than before, but still not positive EV.
5	+420	17.8%	–7.4%	Live price reflected game state; no value.
6	+1600	5.9%	–0.1%	Near settlement; price converged toward fair.

> **Desk rule.** Do not confuse a better-looking price with a good price. A price is good only if it beats fair *after* the cost band.

5 · Prediction markets — a second probability read

Polymarket prices each outcome as a **$0–$1 share**: a $0.53 share means roughly a 53% crowd probability, and it is close to vig-free. The diary's **raw cross-venue edge** is simply the crowd share minus the sportsbook's de-vigged fair:

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raw edge  =  Polymarket share  −  FanDuel de-vigged fair probability
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Snap	FanDuel fair	Polymarket share	Raw edge	Interpretation
1	50.4%	52.0%	+1.6%	Largest early lean, still too small.
2	51.2%	51.5%	+0.3%	Venues nearly identical.
3	52.6%	53.2%	+0.6%	Tiny gap, no lock.
4	47.2%	48.0%	+0.8%	Reversal, but venues still agree.

Snap	FanDuel fair	Polymarket share	Raw edge	Interpretation
5	17.3%	15.4%	–1.9%	Live game state; crowd slightly below book.
6	5.6%	5.3%	–0.3%	Near final, essentially converged.

> **Important distinction.** A positive raw edge is *not* an arbitrage. It only says the crowd price sits above the sportsbook fair price — before any execution cost.

6 · The no-arb band — why small gaps are not free money

To lock a guaranteed payout you must cover *both* sides. That means paying the sportsbook vig embedded in 1 leg and the prediction-market fee plus slippage on the other. Those costs create a no-arb band around fair value.

Possible lock	Leg 1	Leg 2	Why it usually fails
Back Japan + buy NO-Japan	FanDuel Japan fixed odds	Buy NO-Japan shares on Polymarket	Fee/slippage on the share plus the sportsbook price leaves the lock negative.
Buy Japan + back the field	Buy Japan YES shares on Polymarket	Back Sweden/draw field at FanDuel	The field price includes sportsbook hold, so the lock costs too much.

Snap	Raw edge	Best 2-leg lock (after real 0.03 fee + slippage)	Tradeable?
1	+1.6%	–3.1%	No arb
2	+0.3%	–3.9%	No arb
3	+0.6%	–3.9%	No arb
4	+0.8%	–3.6%	No arb
5	–1.9%	–4.5%	No arb
6	–0.3%	–0.9%	No arb

Every raw gap in the whole series sat inside the cost band. The market was efficient enough that **discipline mattered more than chasing a flash.**

7 · Price movement, CLV & the Snap 2 paper trade

- **Steam** = a meaningful move toward a side (odds shorten, probability rises). **Drift** = the opposite (odds lengthen, probability falls).
- **CLV (closing-line value)** = did your entry beat the later market price? It is a *signal* of good timing, not a cash payout.
- **Mark-to-fair** = the paper value of the position using the *current* fair probability. **Sunk vig** = the embedded cost you already paid on entry.

The diary carries 1 illustrative paper position — a $10,000 back of Japan at –115, entered at Snap 2:

Read	FanDuel line	Fair probability	CLV vs entry	Mark-to-fair	Beginner read
Snap 2 (entry)	–115	51.0%	0.0 pts	–$465	Starts negative after the vig.
Snap 3	–125	52.6%	+2.1 pts	–$166	Timing looks good, mark still negative.
Snap 4 (close)	+100	47.2%	–3.5 pts	–$1,176	Reversal wipes out the timing edge.

> **CLV is a signal, not a payout.** Positive CLV can sit next to a negative mark, because the vig was paid at entry. And a sportsbook ticket has no sell button — exiting is a separate problem.

8 · Exiting a sportsbook position — mark vs realizable value

The Snap-4 paper mark of **–$1,176** is a *valuation* at de-vigged fair. It is not an executable price. To actually get out, you cash out or hedge — and both routes cost more than the paper mark.

Exit route	Approx. result	Why
Paper mark (at fair)	–$1,176	A valuation only — not a price you can hit.
Hedge on Polymarket (buy NO-Japan)	≈ –$1,314	Near vig-free, so cheapest — but only if you fill within ~2¢ of mid.
FanDuel Cash Out / hedge the field	≈ –$1,749	1 click, no slippage, but you re-pay the sportsbook hold.

> **The lesson.** A vig-free *share* is genuinely exitable near mid; the same outcome as a sportsbook bet is effectively illiquid. Liquidity — the ability to sell, not just the quoted price — is itself part of the edge.

9 · The match and the 6-snap story

The match is a World Cup Group F decider. **Japan advance with a draw or a win; Sweden must win.** That is why the draw is not filler — it becomes the live result that matters.

Team	Position before match	What the match means
Netherlands	1st on 4 pts	Playing the other final group match.
Japan	2nd on 4 pts	A draw or win sends Japan through.
Sweden	3rd on 3 pts	Needs a win to pass Japan.
Tunisia	4th on 0 pts	Eliminated.

Snap	Time (UTC)	Japan price	Japan fair	Polymarket	Beginner read
1	23 Jun · 06:08 UTC	–115	50.4%	0.520	Opening read: tiny crowd lean, not enough to trade.
2	24 Jun · 07:49 UTC	–115	51.0%	0.515	Book and crowd converge.
3	25 Jun · 06:48 UTC	–125	52.6%	0.5325	Match-day steam toward Japan.
4	25 Jun · 21:46 UTC · pre-kickoff	+100	47.2%	0.480	Final-hour reversal; paper CLV flips negative.
5	26 Jun · 00:45 UTC · in-match	+420	17.3%	0.154	At 1-1 the draw becomes the key result.
6	26 Jun · 00:58 UTC · full time	+1600	5.6%	0.053	Draw resolves the group; a Japan win longshot dies.

Japan-to-win looked like a roughly 50/50 result before the match. It firmed to 52.6% fair, reversed to 47.2% before kickoff, then collapsed once the 1-1 scoreline made the draw the live outcome. **Full time 1-1 — Japan qualified on the draw, exactly as the closing prices implied.**

What each snap teaches

- **Snap 1.** A raw edge can be visible and still not tradeable.
- **Snap 2.** A probability can move even when the favourite's headline odds look unchanged.
- **Snap 3.** Agreement across independent venues signals an efficient market — not an automatic trade.
- **Snap 4.** A timing edge can vanish before the event even starts.
- **Snap 5.** Once the match is on, live game state — not the pre-match model — drives the price.
- **Snap 6.** Near settlement the book and crowd converge; the closing price was right all along.

10 · Glossary & formula sheet

Term	Plain-English meaning
Vig / hold / juice / overround	The book's built-in margin, hidden in the odds.
Implied probability	The probability an odds price represents: 1 / decimal odds.
De-vigged fair probability	Implied probability rescaled so the market adds back to 100%.
No-vig consensus	De-vigged average across rival books — the market's true-probability estimate.
EV (expected value)	Decimal odds × consensus probability − 1. Negative = worse than fair.
Prediction-market share	A $0–$1 contract; $0.53 ≈ 53% crowd probability, ~vig-free.
Raw edge	Crowd share − sportsbook de-vigged fair, before execution costs.
Arbitrage / lock	A 2-sided position designed to guarantee a payout. Rare after fees and slippage.
Steam / drift	Odds shorten (steam) or lengthen (drift) as money and information arrive.
CLV	Closing-line value: did the entry beat the later/closing price?
Slippage	The cost of not filling exactly at the shown price, especially at size.

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Decimal from American  —  negative: 1 + 100 / |odds|  ·  positive: 1 + odds / 100
Implied probability  —  1 / decimal odds
Hold / vig  —  sum of raw implied probabilities − 100%
De-vigged fair  —  raw implied / sum of raw implied
EV per $1  —  decimal odds × no-vig consensus probability − 1
Raw cross-venue edge  —  prediction-market share − sportsbook fair
After-fee lock  —  cost of covering both sides after fees/slippage vs a $1 payout (positive = arb)
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> **Final takeaway.** Most of the edge in this package is not a bet — it is the discipline to reject signals that do not survive de-vigging, consensus comparison, fee-aware lock checks, execution depth, and a fresh-data sanity check.